

Hiring will make or break your business.

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Executive Summary

Hiring exceptional people is the single hardest challenge in building a company. A small team of 10–20 truly "cracked" players can build a billion-dollar business, but finding them demands relentless recruiting volume and an ever-rising hiring bar.

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Hiring Is the Hardest Thing [0:00](#)

- Both speakers agree without hesitation: hiring good people is the single hardest challenge in running a business
- It's described as "hyper niche" — sniffing out whether someone is truly exceptional is an extremely difficult, almost instinctual skill

It's a Volume Game [0:00](#)

- However many interviews you think you need to conduct to find great people, it's usually not enough
- The speakers are investing heavily in recruiting precisely because the pipeline must be much larger than most founders assume
- Recruiting bar should constantly increase — every new hire is an opportunity to raise (or lower) the overall company average

You Only Need 10–20 Cracked People [0:20](#)

- "Cracked" = people who show up on Saturdays, go all-in, operate at an elite level
- The claim: **10–20 truly exceptional people** is enough to build a billion-dollar company — you don't need 100
- The performance gap between tiers is enormous:
 - An A+ player vs. a B+ player is described as roughly a **10x difference**
 - This makes identifying and securing top talent disproportionately valuable

"You literally need like 10, 20, 30 cracked people and you can make like a billion dollar company."

Wrong Hires Can Destroy a Company 0:43

- Every person added who doesn't raise the company average is effectively lowering it
- Bringing in enough wrong people can actively damage or "f*** your company"
- A key diagnostic: do your employees give you energy or take energy away?
 - If team members are draining your energy, their role in the company should be questioned
- "There's levels to this" — the speakers acknowledge that mastering hiring is an ongoing, compounding skill, not a one-time problem to solve